The Mountainside

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New Board, Officers, and Committee Chairs Meet New Challenges for CMA

Water-Sewer Upgrade Work Tops List of 1995/96 Goals

The Coolfont Mountainside Association has begun its new year with the election of a new Board and the subsequent election of new officers. At the annual meeting at Coolfont on Saturday, September 2, Lee Weinberger and Carroll Yingling were elected to replace outgoing members Tim Black and Arleigh Greenblat. Anne-Marie Doppman was re-elected for a third term. Those attending represented 60 votes and there were 54 proxies. The FY96 budget was approved; various changes to the By-Laws were approved after one proposal was eliminated by the members attending; and the draft proposed covenant changes were reviewed.

NEW OFFICERS

On September 11, in a short organizational meeting of the new Board at the Doppman residence, Jackson Bain was elected President, Carroll Yingling was elected Vice President, Anne-Marie Treasurer was re-elected Treasurer. As a result of a bylaws review and general discussion that the Secretary need not be a Board member and the observation that this would permit all Board members to concentrate on the issues being discussed, Jim Bradfield, previously the Corresponding Secretary, was elected Board Secretary. All officers were elected by unanimous votes of the Board.

OCTOBER 2 BOARD MEETING HIGHLIGHTS

After several hours of discussion the Board agreed to act as its own general contractor for the water sewer upgrade project. John Lewis had obtained individual estimates from the companies who would have worked on the water upgrade as sub-contractors. The Board accepted the proposal that CMA get individual contracts with these companies. While the total cost will be higher than the original Lewis estimate, the Board believes that some shuffling of future funding will enable CMA to stay within the total $365,000 infrastructure budget approved by the membership. The Board also believes that the project's phased schedule will enable the $230,000 budgeted for FY96 to be sufficient. The balance of the project cost will stretch into FY97. An Upgrade Implementation Team, chaired by Lee Weinberger and composed of Don Fox, Elmer Broxson, Arleigh Greenblat and Linda Clark will actively monitor the construction progress and report back to the Board.

Just a reminder: we have not forgotten those of you who have volunteered to loan CMA money to finance the upgrades. Each of you will be receiving a thank you note outlining the procedure we will be following on calling in the loans as our financial position requires the money. A repayment schedule will also be attached to the note.

COMMITTEE CHAIRS

The Board unanimously approved the 1995/96 Committee Chairs:

Bob Dowling - Finance (Anne-Marie Doppman Board liaison)

Linda Clark - DACC (Harold Radday Board liaison)

Tim Black - Recreation (Carroll Yingling Board liaison)

SEPTIC TANK INSPECTION

One project to begin over the next several months is an effort to concentrate on those residences which our records indicate should have their septic tanks inspected and emptied, if it is deemed necessary. This periodic service is necessary to maintain the efficiency of our settling pond/wetland cell cleansing operation in reducing our effluent discharge into Sir John's Run stream to meet West Virginia state approved levels.

Each inspection and cleaning will be at the personal expense of the homeowner. The cost estimate is between $140 and $170. Homeowners will be advised by letter beforehand. Low overhanging tree limbs may need to be trimmed to enable the septic truck to reach the septic tanks.

FUTURE BOARD MEETINGS

All CMA Members Welcome!

November 8 - 7PM Davis Library, Bethesda, MD
December 2 - 9AM Steinberg Coolfont residence
January 17 - 7PM location to be announced
February 3 - 9AM Davis Library, Bethesda, MD
March 2 - 9AM Davis Library, Bethesda, MD
April 20 - 9AM Coolfont, location to be announced
June 1 - 9AM Davis Library, Bethesda, MD
July 27 - Annual Meeting, Coolfont

COVENANT AMENDMENTS

The amendment proposals are being reviewed by the Board.

GENERAL FINANCE

At the October meeting Anne-Marie Doppman reported that nine members are delinquent in the payment of their water bills and 15 members are delinquent in the payment of their current assessment.

WATER METER READINGS

CMA homeowners should be aware that the next scheduled water meter reading will be November 15. The bills will be mailed by that weekend. We regret that the deadline for payment will be the week before Christmas (but Merry Christmas anyway!)

WINTERIZING YOUR HOME

Also, it is not too early to begin thinking about winterizing your home for the winter if your home will be infrequently used during the winter season. Forecasters predict this winter will be somewhere between the mild winter of last year and the horrible winter two years ago when there was a rash of leaks attributable to the cold weather.

NO OPEN BURNING ON MOUNTAINSIDE

1995 has been one of the most dangerous years for forest fires in recent memory, and the prevention of a forest fire on our mountainside should be on everyone's mind. The newly-approved regulations of CMA's Development and Architectural Control Committee now strictly prohibit open burning, because it produces sparks, which produce fires.

Here's the language:

> Exterior fires are permitted only in barbecue receptacles. Barbecue receptacles are defined as factory manufactured metal enclosures, such as a barbecue grill or portable metal exterior fireplace. These receptacles should be in good shape, i.e., not rusting out or containing holes for sparks to escape. Those in disrepair shall be replaced. DACC approved and permanently installed stone or brick barbecues with chimneys and spark arresters are also permitted. Barbecue receptacles must be certified by the DACC and may require re-certification from time to time. Open fires on or in the ground are not permitted under any circumstances.

The message here is simple: Don't start a bonfire on the mountainside, even if it is on your own property. None of us can afford to replace all that would be lost if a fire started here.

GOT SOME TIME? VOLUNTEER!

Call a committee chair or board liaison and volunteer a little time and effort! We need your ideas, your experience, and your common love of this mountainside more than ever this year!

NOTE: NEW CMA MEMBER DIRECTORIES TO BE PRINTED THIS MONTH! DO YOU HAVE CHANGES?